

Anti-bribery and Corruption Policy Template (UK)

This Anti-bribery and Corruption Policy (U.K.) is designed to help organisations prevent bribery and corruption, protect their reputation and guide ethical business conduct in compliance with the U.K. Bribery Act 2010.

Note: This document is a draft policy and is subject to further review and expansion. It is intended for general informational purposes only and does not constitute legal, financial or other professional advice. Please consult with qualified professional advisors as necessary to draft appropriate policies for your organisation.

[Organisation Name]

Policy title: Anti-bribery and Corruption Policy (U.K.)

Effective date: [Date]

Last updated: [Date]

Policy owner: [Position or department]

1. Purpose

This policy sets out [Organisation name]'s commitment to conducting business ethically and in full compliance with the U.K. Bribery Act 2010. Its purpose is to prevent bribery and corruption, ensure transparent practices and protect the organization's reputation and stakeholders.

2. Scope

This policy applies to:

- All employees, officers, and directors of [Organisation name].
- Contractors, consultants, intermediaries, joint venture partners and any third parties representing the organisation.
- All business activities, whether in the U.K. or abroad.

3. Policy statement

[Organisation name] prohibits all forms of bribery and corruption. No person acting for or on behalf of the organisation may, directly or indirectly:

- Offer, give, request or accept a bribe of any kind.
- Make facilitation payments (small payments intended to speed up routine government actions), which are strictly prohibited under the U.K. Bribery Act.
- Provide or accept hospitality, gifts or expenses intended to improperly influence a decision.
- Fail to prevent bribery in any part of the organisation or its associated persons.

4. Definitions

- **Bribery:** Offering, giving, requesting or accepting an advantage to influence an action improperly.
- **Advantage:** Includes money, gifts, hospitality, services, employment opportunities or anything else of value.
- **Associated persons:** Anyone who performs services for or on behalf of the organisation, e.g., employees, contractors, agents, subsidiaries.

5. Gifts, hospitality and expenses

Reasonable and proportionate hospitality or gifts are permitted only if they are:

- Intended to build legitimate business relationships, not to secure an improper advantage.
- Of modest value, infrequent and transparent.
- Approved in advance when required and recorded accurately in company records.

6. Charitable and political contributions

Charitable donations must be genuine and not used as a form of bribery. Political donations made on behalf of the organisation are prohibited unless specifically approved by the board and compliant with applicable laws.

7. Facilitation payments

Facilitation payments are prohibited under the U.K. Bribery Act. Employees must refuse such payments and report any requests immediately.

8. Third-party relationships

The organisation may be held liable for bribery committed by third parties acting on its behalf. Therefore:

- Due diligence must be conducted before engaging third parties.
- Contracts must include anti-bribery clauses.
- Payments must be transparent, proportionate and properly documented.

9. Recordkeeping

All transactions must be fully and accurately recorded. False or misleading entries are prohibited. Financial controls must ensure transparency and detect improper payments.

10. Training and awareness

All employees and associated persons will receive training on this policy and the U.K. Bribery Act to ensure awareness of obligations and risks.

11. Reporting concerns



Employees and third parties are encouraged to report concerns or suspicions of bribery through [hotline/email/reporting channel]. Reports will be investigated promptly and confidentially, with no retaliation for good-faith reporting.

12. Enforcement and disciplinary action

Breaches of this policy are serious offenses and may result in disciplinary action, including dismissal, termination of contracts or legal proceedings. Individuals may face criminal liability, including imprisonment and fines.

13. Compliance responsibility

The compliance officer (or designated person) is responsible for overseeing this policy, providing guidance and monitoring adherence. Employees are individually responsible for ensuring their conduct complies with the policy.

14. Review and updates

This policy will be reviewed annually and updated as necessary to ensure continued compliance with the U.K. Bribery Act and evolving best practices.

15. Contact us

If you have any questions or concerns about this policy or your personal information, please contact us at:

[Organisation name]

[Address]

[Email]

[Phone number]

Approval:

Policy Owner: [Position/Name]

Date approved: [Date]